

WORLD'S PEOPLE

It is very difficult to calculate the world's total population—you can't just ask everyone to stand still for a day while they are all carefully counted. So population figures are always estimates, but demographers calculate that in July 2007 the world's population broke through the 6.6 billion barrier, and is still rising at a rate of roughly 3 people a second, which is 10,800 an hour, 259,200 a day, and 1,814,400 a week!

Population growth

For most of human history, the population has grown slowly, only reaching 1 billion (1,000 million) by the year 1800. But in the last 10 years, it has shot past 6 billion and is heading towards an estimated 9 billion by 2050, by which time many scientists expect the rate of growth to slow down or even reverse slightly.

280 million

480 million

2,500 million

6,835 million

c9,000 million

AD1

1500

1950

2010

2050

You can count on me.

Oceania: 33,560,095
0.5% of world's population

South America: 379,922,707
6% of world's population

North America: 522,847,395
8% of world's population

Europe: 729,861,490
11% of world's population

Africa: 934,499,752
14% of world's population

People per continent

Six out of every 10 people alive today live in Asia; the vast majority in the big cities of India, China, Japan, and Korea.

The rest of the world's population is slightly more evenly spread out across five other continents. No one lives permanently in Antarctica.

I'm not a number.

Don't push!

I stand to be counted!

Big and small

The Russian Federation is by far the biggest country in the world, but China is the most heavily populated, with 20 percent of the world's total. The smallest country in both size and population is Vatican City in Rome, home to just 800 people.

Asia: 4,001,633,990
60.5% of world's population

Age structure

Roughly 27.5 percent of the world's population is age 14 or under. The vast majority—65 percent—are between 15 and 64, with the remaining 7.5 percent being age 65 or over. The average person alive today is 28 and can expect to live to 64 if a man, and 68 if a woman, but of course this figure varies considerably around the world.

I need structure in my life.

That figures.



Gro China!